

HARRISON MITCHELL

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EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego

2021–2027 (expected)

Ph.D. in Economics

Advisors: Nir Jaimovich & Samuel Bazzi

Macalester College

2015–2019

B.A. in Economics, with honors

Minor in English Literature

RESEARCH FIELDS

Macroeconomics, Development Economics

REFERENCES

Nir Jaimovich, Professor

Department of Economics, UCSD

nijaimovich@ucsd.edu

Juan Herreño, Assistant Professor

Department of Economics, UCSD

jherrenolopera@ucsd.edu

Samuel Bazzi, Professor

Department of Economics, UCSD

sbazzi@ucsd.edu

Gaurav Khanna, Associate Professor

School of Global Policy and Strategy, UCSD

gakhanna@ucsd.edu

JOB MARKET PAPER

The Curse of Connectivity: Evidence from Indonesia's Village Resettlement Program

Does connecting a village to markets make it richer? I study how market access affects long-run development using Indonesia's Transmigration program, which created new villages with variation in initial connectivity, and find that villages that began more connected are poorer today. A one standard deviation increase in initial market access lowers GDP per capita decades later by roughly 4 percent. The lower measured incomes are not explained by lower local prices, compensating amenities, or people and production relocating elsewhere. Rather than limiting structural transformation, higher connectivity shifts village residents out of agriculture and into local non-farm work. The evidence points instead to a scale externality in agricultural production. Using separate variation in villages' initial settlement sizes, I estimate that agricultural productivity rises with the size of the agricultural workforce. Workers leaving agriculture do not internalize the resulting productivity loss, so this scale externality can cause reallocation to reduce long-run incomes. A spatial general equilibrium model of Indonesia with the estimated externality reproduces the negative effect of market access on income without targeting it. In counterfactuals, ignoring the externality overstates the aggregate gains by 18 percent for road-network improvements and by 64 percent for increases in rural agricultural productivity. An agricultural earnings subsidy at the road program's fiscal outlay delivers twice its rural gains.

PUBLICATIONS

Herder-Related Violence, Labor Allocation, and the Gendered Response of Agricultural Households

with Jeffrey Bloem, Amy Damon, and David Francis

Journal of Development Economics, Volume 176, 2025

Migration and the Labor Market Impacts of COVID-19

with Nathan Barker, C. Austin Davis, Paula López-Peña, Mushfiq Mobarak, Karim Naguib, Maira Reimão, Ashish Shenoy, and Corey Vernot

European Economic Review, Volume 158, 2023

WORKING PAPERS

Delegation Risk and Implementation at Scale: Evidence from a Migration Loan Program in Bangladesh

with Mushfiq Mobarak, Karim Naguib, Maira Reimão, and Ashish Shenoy

Revise and Resubmit, *Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics*

The Global Value of Cities

with Aakash Bhalothia, Gavin Engelstad, and Gaurav Khanna

WORK IN PROGRESS

Build it and They Will Modernize: Structural Change and Village Creation

Land Inequality and Rural Structural Transformation: Evidence from India

with Manaswini Rao and Frances Lu

AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS, AND GRANTS

PhD Research Grant (STEG-CEPR) (£15,000) 2023

PhD Research Grant (STEG-CEPR) (£15,000) 2022

Summer Graduate Research Fellowship, Economics Department, UCSD 2022–2023

Regents Fellowship, UCSD 2021–2022

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Yale University – Research Assistant for Mushfiq Mobarak 2019–2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of California, San Diego – Teaching Assistant 2021–Present
ECON 1, ECON 3, ECON 4, ECON 100B, ECON 110A, ECON 129, GPCO 403, GPEC 450

Macalester College – Teaching Assistant 2017–2019
Intermediate Macroeconomics (ECON 371)

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2026 STEG Annual Conference; Urbanization and Development Annual Conference; Firms, Trade, and Development; Urban Economics Association North America Meeting*

2025 STEG Annual Conference, UCSD

2024 Southern California Applied Economics Conference, UCSD

* *scheduled*

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee: *Journal of Development Economics*, *Food Policy*

COMPUTER SKILLS

Stata, MATLAB, Python, R, QGIS

LANGUAGES

English (native), Spanish (intermediate)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Citizenship: USA